

VAMPIRE LINEAGES



WE PRESENT FOUR DISTINCT VAMPIRE LINEAGES: Beastbound, Grotesque, Sovereign, and Blood Priest.

Vampire Lineages is a monster supplement for 5e that presents vampires not as a single aristocratic archetype, but as divergent expressions of undeath shaped by different philosophies of power. Instead of relying on one vampire stat block repeated with minor variations, this book presents four distinct Lineage structures: primal wilderness predators, subterranean horrors, manipulative aristocratic rulers, and ritualistic cult patriarchs.

These are not separate species. They are divergent Lineage traditions.

The intent of this product is vampiric doctrine and domain specialization. Beastbound vampires represent predatory supremacy and the rule of wilderness territories. Grotesque represent degeneration, corruption, and subterranean infestation beneath civilization. Sovereign vampires represent aristocratic control, political manipulation, and shadow rule over cities and courts. Blood Priest vampires represent ritual ascension, cult leadership, and religious devotion to the power of blood.

Each Lineage escalates not only in strength, but in authority, territory, and supernatural dominance.

Geography, alliances, and rivalries are intentionally undefined. These vampires may represent isolated monsters ruling small domains, ancient dynasties manipulating entire kingdoms, secret cult leaders hiding in forgotten temples, or primal predators stalking deep forests. They are not meant to replace traditional vampires—they are variations of the same cursed immortality shaped by different beliefs, instincts, and domains of power.

Whether these Lineages compete, coexist, secretly manipulate one another, or descend from the same ancient progenitor is left entirely in the GM's hands.

BEASTBOUND LINEAGE

"THE WILDERNESS BELONGS TO THE STRONGEST predator."

Beastbound vampires reject civilization and rule through primal dominance. They see themselves as the apex predators of the natural world, masters of wilderness territories where fang and claw decide authority.

Their domains are forests, mountains, frozen tundras, and wild coasts where the laws of civilization fade. Wolves, bats, and other beasts often gather around their presence, sensing the unnatural predator at the center of the territory.

Hierarchy among Beastbound vampires is determined by raw dominance and hunting supremacy.

Beastbound vampires are designed for:

- Wilderness predator encounters
- Pack-driven hunting battles
- Territorial domain conflicts
- Ambushes in forests, mountains, and wild lands

They do not manipulate kingdoms. They rule the hunt.

GROTESQUE LINEAGE

"CIVILIZATION ROTS FROM BENEATH."

Grotesque vampires embody the monstrous degeneration of the curse. Twisted, pale, and predatory, they dwell beneath civilization in ruins, catacombs, forgotten fortresses, and sewer labyrinths.

Where other vampires rule openly or secretly among mortals, Grotesque infest the forgotten places beneath cities. They thrive in darkness, terrorizing underground passages and striking from hidden tunnels.

Their power is built not through charm, but through fear and territorial control of subterranean domains.

Grotesque vampires are designed for:

- Dungeon horror encounters
- Subterranean ambush battles
- Urban undercity infestations
- Catacomb and ruin exploration

They do not seduce. They infest.

SOVEREIGN LINEAGE

“POWER IS NOT TAKEN WITH CLAWS. IT IS GRANTED WITH *obedience.*”

Sovereign vampires embody the classic aristocratic image of vampirism: rulers of courts, manipulators of politics, and masters of influence. They build networks of power among nobles, merchants, and institutions, controlling entire regions without revealing their true nature.

Their domains are castles, noble estates, court halls, and shadow governments. Mortals may serve them willingly, unknowingly, or under supernatural influence.

Hierarchy among Sovereign vampires is defined by influence, lineage, and control over mortal systems of power.

Sovereign vampires are designed for:

- Court intrigue encounters
- Political manipulation campaigns
- Social dominance scenarios
- Urban power struggles

They do not hunt openly. They rule from the throne.

BLOOD PRIEST LINEAGE

“BLOOD IS NOT A CURSE. IT IS A SACRAMENT.”

Blood Priest vampires see undeath not as a punishment, but as divine transformation. They build cults devoted to the power of blood, ritual sacrifice, and the ascension of chosen followers.

Their domains are temples, hidden sanctums, sacrificial chambers, and secret cult strongholds. Followers gather willingly to offer devotion—and sometimes their lives—to empower their immortal master.

Hierarchy among Blood Priest vampires is defined by religious authority and the strength of their cult.

Blood Priest vampires are designed for:

- Cult-driven adventures
- Ritual encounter scenarios
- Temple and sanctum battles
- Fanatical follower confrontations

They do not hide their power. They sanctify it.

BEASTBOUND LINEAGE

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Wild Warden	4	Daylight tracker and territory keeper who patrols the wilderness domain of its vampire master, guiding beasts and weakening prey before the hunt begins.
Elder Beastbound Vampire	12	Apex wilderness predator who dominates its territory through raw hunting supremacy, commanding beasts and ambushing intruders across forests and wild frontiers.
Ancient Beastbound Vampire	16	Mythic lord of the hunt whose presence turns entire regions into predatory domains where wolves, bats, and other creatures serve the will of the ultimate hunter.

GROTESQUE LINEAGE

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Graveblade Agent	4	Subterranean scout and infiltrator who maintains tunnel networks, lures victims into underground traps, and protects the hidden resting places of its monstrous master.
Elder Grotesque	12	Twisted ruler of ruins, catacombs, and buried fortresses who dominates dark passageways through terror, ambush, and ruthless territorial control.
Ancient Grotesque	16	Primeval horror of the undercity whose lair spreads through labyrinthine tunnels and ancient ruins, turning entire underground complexes into hunting grounds of fear.

SOVEREIGN LINEAGE

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
Chamberlain Operative	4	Trusted agent and daylight enforcer who protects the interests of a ruling vampire through diplomacy, intrigue, and calculated violence.
Elder Sovereign Vampire	12	Aristocratic manipulator who rules through charm, influence, and carefully orchestrated power within courts, noble houses, and political systems.
Ancient Sovereign Vampire	16	Shadow monarch whose dominion extends across cities and kingdoms, maintaining control through networks of servants, secrets, and supernatural authority.

BLOOD PRIEST LINEAGE

Name	Challenge Rating	Description
High Acolyte of the Vein	4	Fanatical cult leader who conducts blood rituals, recruits followers, and protects the sacred sanctum of its vampire patriarch.
Elder Blood Priest	12	Ritual master who draws power from sacrifice and devotion, commanding cultists and channeling dark rites to strengthen its dominion.
Ancient Blood Patriarch	16	Divine tyrant of a blood cult whose temple domains pulse with sacrificial power and whose followers offer their lives in reverence to the immortal master.

ELDER GROTESQUE

Medium undead (shapechanger), lawful evil

Armor Class 17 (natural armor)

Hit Points 180 (19d8 + 95)

Speed 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
20 (+5)	18 (+4)	20 (+5)	15 (+2)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +8, Wis +7, Cha +7

Skills Perception +7, Stealth +12

Damage Resistances necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 17

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 12 (8,400 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +4

Regeneration. This vampire regains 20 hit points at the start of its turn if it has at least 1 hit point and isn't in sunlight or running water. If this vampire takes radiant damage or damage from holy water, this trait doesn't function at the start of its next turn.

Spider Climb. This vampire can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

Subterranean Predator. While in dim light or darkness, this vampire has advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks and can attempt to hide even when only lightly obscured.

Sunlight Hypersensitivity. While in sunlight, this vampire takes 20 radiant damage at the start of its turn, and it has disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks.

Forbiddance. This vampire can't enter a residence without an invitation from one of the occupants.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). When this vampire fails a saving throw it can choose to succeed instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This vampire makes two attacks, only one of which can be a bite attack.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 12 (2d6 + 5) slashing damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 17).

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one willing creature, or a creature that is grappled by the Grotesque, incapacitated, or restrained. *Hit:* 8 (1d6 + 5) piercing damage plus 21 (6d6) necrotic damage. The target's hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the necrotic damage taken.

Shapechanger. If this vampire isn't in sunlight or running water, it can use its action to polymorph into a Tiny bat or a Medium cloud of mist, or back into its true form.

BONUS ACTIONS

Darkness Pulse (Recharge 5–6). Magical darkness spreads in a 20-foot radius centered on this vampire and lasts until the end of its next turn.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

This vampire can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn.

Move (1 Action). This vampire moves up to its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Claw Attack (1 Action). This vampire makes one claw attack.

Shadow Hide (2 Actions). This vampire attempts to hide if it is in dim light or darkness.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), this vampire can take one of the following lair actions; it can't use the same effect two rounds in a row.

Extinguish Light. All nonmagical light sources within 60 feet are extinguished, and magical light of 3rd level or lower within that area is suppressed until the next initiative count 20.

Crawling Shadows. Living shadows grasp at creatures the Grotesque can see within 60 feet. Each target must succeed on a DC 16 Strength saving throw or have its speed reduced to 0 until the start of its next turn.

Tunnel Shift. Loose stone, debris, or shifting masonry alters the battlefield. One 20-foot-square area of ground the Grotesque can see becomes difficult terrain until the next initiative count 20.

- This vampire fights almost exclusively in darkness and confined terrain.
- It uses vertical surfaces, ceilings, and hidden passages to break line of sight and isolate prey.
- It grapples and drains separated victims while retreating through tunnels to divide the party.

ELDER GROTESQUE



SOVEREIGN LINEAGE

CHAMBERLAIN OPERATIVE

Medium humanoid (any race), lawful evil

Armor Class 16 (breastplate)

Hit Points 78 (12d8 + 24)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +5, Cha +5

Skills Deception +5, Insight +3, Perception +3, Persuasion +7

Senses passive Perception 13

Languages Common plus two others

Challenge 4 (1,100 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +2

Courtly Authority. The chamberlain operative has advantage on Charisma (Deception) and Charisma (Persuasion) checks made in social encounters with humanoids.

Disciplined Combatant. The chamberlain operative has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. The chamberlain operative makes two rapier attacks.

Rapier. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target.
Hit: 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage.

Commanding Rebuke. The chamberlain operative targets one creature it can see within 30 feet. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on its next attack roll before the end of its next turn.

REACTIONS

Interpose. When a creature the chamberlain operative can see hits a friendly creature within 5 feet with an attack, the operative can impose disadvantage on the attack roll.

- A chamberlain operative protects its vampire master through discipline and positioning rather than brute force.
- It attempts to control the flow of battle while the vampire manipulates or dominates enemies.
- In public settings, it acts as bodyguard, political fixer, and enforcer.



ANCIENT SOVEREIGN VAMPIRE

Medium undead (shapechanger), lawful evil

Armor Class 18 (natural armor)

Hit Points 265 (30d8 + 120)

Speed 30 ft., climb 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
19 (+4)	18 (+4)	20 (+5)	18 (+4)	18 (+4)	22 (+6)

Saving Throws Dex +9, Wis +9, Cha +11

Skills Deception +16, Insight +9, Perception +9, Persuasion +16

Damage Resistances necrotic; bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Senses darkvision 120 ft., passive Perception 19

Languages Common plus four others

Challenge 16 (15,000 XP)

Proficiency Bonus +5

Regeneration. This vampire regains 30 hit points at the start of its turn if it has at least 1 hit point and isn't in sunlight or running water. If this vampire takes radiant damage or damage from holy water, this trait doesn't function at the start of its next turn.

Spider Climb. This vampire can climb difficult surfaces, including upside down on ceilings, without needing to make an ability check.

Master of Influence. This vampire has advantage on Charisma (Deception) and Charisma (Persuasion) checks.

Sunlight Hypersensitivity. While in sunlight, this vampire takes 20 radiant damage at the start of its turn, and it has disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks.

Forbiddance. This vampire can't enter a residence without an invitation from one of the occupants.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). When this vampire fails a saving throw it can choose to succeed instead.

ACTIONS

Multiattack. This vampire makes two attacks, only one of which can be a bite attack.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d6 + 4) slashing damage and the target is grappled (escape DC 17).

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +9 to hit, reach 5 ft., one willing creature, or a creature that is grappled by the vampire, incapacitated, or restrained. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) piercing damage plus 28 (8d6) necrotic damage. The target's hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the necrotic damage taken.

Dominating Charm. One humanoid This vampire can see within 30 feet must succeed on a DC 18 Wisdom saving throw or be charmed by the vampire.

Shapechanger. If this vampire isn't in sunlight or running water, it can use its action to polymorph into a Tiny bat or a Medium cloud of mist, or back into its true form.

LEGENDARY ACTIONS

This vampire can take 3 legendary actions, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn.

Move (1 Action). This vampire moves up to its speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Claw Attack (1 Action). This vampire makes one claw attack.

Command Thrall (2 Actions). One charmed creature the vampire can see within 60 feet can immediately move up to its speed and make one weapon attack.

LAIR ACTIONS

On initiative count 20 (losing initiative ties), this vampire can take one of the following lair actions; it can't use the same effect two rounds in a row.

Crushing Authority. Each creature of the vampire's choice within 60 feet must succeed on a DC 18 Wisdom saving throw or have disadvantage on attack rolls until the next initiative count 20.

Compelling Presence. One creature the vampire can see within 60 feet must succeed on a DC 18 Wisdom saving throw or be frightened until the next initiative count 20.

Shadowed Court. Dim light fills a 40-foot-radius area centered on the vampire until the next initiative count 20.

- This vampire manipulates enemies before committing to melee combat.
- It maintains charmed thralls and uses them to divide and pressure opponents.
- It withdraws when threatened, relying on servants, dominated creatures, and political influence to control the battlefield.

ANCIENT SOVEREIGN VAMPIRE



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